

CANDIDATE SURNAME

OTHER NAMES

CENTRE NUMBER

CANDIDATE NUMBER

Pearson Edexcel GCSE (9–1)**HISTORY · PAPER 3: MODERN DEPTH STUDY**

Time: 1 hour 20 minutes (Complete Mock) · 52 Marks (+4 SPaG)

Option 33: Conflict at Home and Abroad: the USA, 1954–75**Key Topic 1: The Development of the Civil Rights Movement, 1954–60**

Comprehensive 11-Page Specification Practice Pack · 1954–1960

PAPER
REFERENCE**1H10/33****Instructions:** Use black ink or ball-point pen. Fill in candidate details above.

- Answer ALL questions in Section A (Question 1 and Question 2).
- Answer ALL questions in Section B (Question 3(a), 3(b), 3(c), and 3(d)).
- Read the Section B Historical Enquiry Dossier carefully on Page 5 before attempting Questions 3(a)–(d).

TOTAL MARKS

56

(52 + 4 SPaG)

Advice: Spend approx. 15 minutes on Section A Q1–Q2, and 60 minutes on Section B Q3(a)–(d). **SPaG:** 4 marks are awarded for spelling, punctuation, grammar, and specialist terms on Q3(d).

Q	TYPE	SPECIFICATION TOPIC FOCUS	PAGE	MARKS	AUDIT
SECTION A: TIMED EXAM PAPER (COMPULSORY QUESTION 1 & QUESTION 2)					
Q1	INFERENCE	Source A: Jim Crow Railway Sign (Jacksonville, FL)	P2	[4]	☐ / 4
Q2	EXPLAIN WHY	Obstacles to Southern Black Voter Registration (Early 1950s)	P3	[12]	☐ / 12
SECTION B: HISTORICAL ENQUIRY & INTERPRETATIONS (INTEGRATED 36M + 4 SPAG)					
Dossier	ENQUIRY	Dossier: Montgomery Bus Boycott (Sources B, C & Ints 1, 2)	P4	Dossier	☐ / Read
3 (a)	UTILITY	Sources B & C: Reasons for Success of Montgomery Boycott	P5	[8]	☐ / 8
3 (b)	DIFFERENCE	Interpretations 1 & 2: Main Difference in Views on Boycott	P6	[4]	☐ / 4
3 (c)	REASON	Interpretations 1 & 2: Reasons for Difference in Historical Views	P6	[4]	☐ / 4
3 (d)	ESSAY	Evaluative Essay: How Far Do You Agree with Interpretation 1?	P7–8	[20]	☐ / 20
4	DEPTH BOOSTER	Spec Depth: Why Brown v. Board Met Intense Resistance	P9	[12]	☐ / 12
SECTION C: GRADE 8/9 STANDARDS & EXAM TRAPS (SELF & PEER ASSESSMENT)					
Exemplars	SECTION A MODELS	Full Level 2 Model Q1 & Level 4 Model Q2 Essay + Examiner Marks	P10	Audit	☐ Verified
Exemplars	SECTION B MODELS	Full Level 3 Model Q3a, Q3b, Q3c & Level 4 Q3d Model + Top 3 Traps	P11	Audit	☐ Verified

Source A: Segregated Municipal Railway Waiting Room, Jacksonville, Florida, early 1950s

US National Archives • Record Group 21 / Southern Railway Photographic Records



A large metal sign suspended above the municipal terminal entrance reads: "COLORED WAITING ROOM" with dual directional arrows pointing towards the segregated facility. Under Jim Crow laws, Black travelers were strictly relegated to separate facilities under penalty of fine or imprisonment.

Provenance: Official photograph documenting Jim Crow segregation signage at a Southern passenger terminal, early 1950s (Library of Congress / National Archives).

1 Give two things you can infer from Source A about racial segregation in the American South in the early 1950s. (4)

(I) INFERENCE 1:

What I can infer from Source A:

Details in the source that tell me this:

(II) INFERENCE 2:

What I can infer from Source A:

Details in the source that tell me this:

Candidate Response Lines:

Spend approx. 15 minutes on Question 2. Construct three developed causal paragraphs.

2 Explain why it was difficult for Black Americans in the Southern states to register to vote in the early 1950s. (12)

(You must also use information of your own.)

A fundamental obstacle was... Furthermore, ...

This was reinforced by... Consequently, ... As a result, ...

Paragraph 2 Focus: Paragraph 2: Terror & Physical Violence — KKK night raids, firebombings, and lynchings operating with total judicial immunity.

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Complete your causation essay with a developed third paragraph and criteria evaluation.

Q2: DEVELOPED CAUSATION

**SPEC
GUARANTEE**

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☐ 3 Developed Causal Factors ☐ Beyond Stimulus Own Fact ☐ Explicit Connectives ☐ Sustained Analytical Focus

SECTION B: HISTORICAL ENQUIRY DOSSIER

Read this archival dossier carefully. All questions in Section B (Questions 3a–3d) relate to these materials.

HISTORICAL ENQUIRY FOCUS: THE REASONS FOR THE SUCCESS OF THE MONTGOMERY BUS BOYCOTT (1955–56) PAPER 3 · SECTION B

Source B: From a protest flyer mimeographed and distributed in Montgomery, 2 December 1955

Alabama Department of Archives and History

"Another woman has been arrested and thrown into jail because she refused to get up out of her seat on the bus for a white person... This has to be stopped. Negroes have rights too. If Negroes did not ride the buses, they could not operate; three-fourths of the riders are Negroes. We are asking every Negro to stay off the buses on Monday in protest of the arrest and trial. Don't ride the buses to work, to town, to school, or anywhere on Monday. If you must work, take a cab, or share a ride, or walk."

Provenance: Protest leaflet written and mimeographed overnight by Jo Ann Robinson and the Women's Political Council (WPC), distributing 35,000 copies.

Source C: From an address by Dr Martin Luther King Jr. to the Montgomery Improvement Association, 5 December 1955

Martin Luther King Jr. Papers Project

"We are here this evening for serious business. We are here in a general sense because first and foremost we are American citizens, and we are determined to apply our citizenship to the fullness of its meaning... There comes a time when people get tired of being trampled over by the iron feet of oppression. Our method will be that of persuasion, not coercion. We will say to the people: let your conscience be your guide. Our actions must be guided by the highest Christian principles of love and non-violence."

Provenance: Speech delivered by Dr Martin Luther King Jr. at Holt Street Baptist Church to over 5,000 citizens at the first mass rally of the boycott.

Interpretation 1

HISTORIOGRAPHY

From Historian Danielle L. McGuire, 'At the Dark End of the Street: Black Women, Rape, and Resistance' (2010):

"The Montgomery Bus Boycott was fundamentally the achievement of organized Black working-class women. Long before national male leaders arrived, Jo Ann Robinson and the Women's Political Council had methodically planned a bus strike. Within hours of Rosa Parks' arrest, Robinson spent the night mimeographing 35,000 leaflets. Over the next 381 days, thousands of domestic maids and cooks walked up to twelve miles a day in freezing winter and blistering summer, while local drivers ran an intricate 300-car dispatch network. It was this daily grassroots courage and economic sacrifice—depriving the bus company of over 70% of its passengers—that brought Montgomery to its knees."

Interpretation 2

HISTORIOGRAPHY

From Historian David L. Lewis, 'King: A Critical Biography' (1970):

"While grassroots logistics sustained the boycott, the movement achieved national momentum and ultimate victory because of the charismatic moral leadership of Dr Martin Luther King Jr. King provided the strategic vision and rhetorical genius that unified disparate local factions and prevented violent retaliation despite firebombings and arrests. He framed the local dispute as a national crusade for Christian justice, attracting essential northern financial support and national media coverage. Crucially, local economic pressure alone could not change municipal segregation laws; success ultimately depended on the legal strategy that secured the Supreme Court's Browder v. Gayle ruling."

Enquiry Core: Source B & C provide contemporary primary evidence; Interpretations 1 & 2 provide competing modern historical views. Keep Page 5 open for Q3(a)–(d)

Spend approx. 12 minutes on Question 3(a). Evaluate content, provenance (COP), and context.

3 (a) Study Sources B and C. How useful are Sources B and C for an enquiry into the reasons for the success (8) of the Montgomery Bus Boycott (1955–56)?

Contextual Knowledge: Mention the 381-day duration, the 300-car pool network, the Browder v. Gayle Supreme Court ruling (Nov 1956), and violent white backlash.

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SECTION B: TIMED EXAM PAPER • QUESTION 3(B) & 3(C)

Spend approx. 5 minutes on Q3(b) and 5 minutes on Q3(c). Write in concise, focused prose.

Q3(B) & Q3(C): INTERPRETATIONS [8M]

3 (b) Study Interpretations 1 and 2. They give different views about the main reason why the Montgomery Bus Boycott succeeded. What is the main difference between these views? Explain your answer, using details from both interpretations. (4)

Direct Contrast Frame: Interpretation 1 argues that... whereas Interpretation 2 argues that...

3 (c) Suggest one reason why Interpretations 1 and 2 give different views about the main reason why the Montgomery Bus Boycott succeeded. You may use Sources B and C to help explain your answer. (4)

Different Views Frame: The historians give different views because they have relied on different sources/evidence. Interpretation 1 is supported by Source B, which emphasizes... whereas Interpretation 2 is supported by Source C, which emphasizes...

Spend approx. 25 minutes on Question 3(d). 16 marks for content + 4 marks for SPaG.

3 (d) How far do you agree with Interpretation 2 about the reasons for the success of the Montgomery Bus Boycott (1955–56)? (16 + 4 SPaG)

- Points in Int 2 that are valid
- Evidence from Source C supporting this
- Specific contextual knowledge backing it

- Counter-argument in Int 1
- Evidence from Source B supporting this
- Specific contextual knowledge backing it

- Grassroots economic mobilization (WPC, 300-car pool, walking 381 days, 70% revenue loss)
- Charismatic moral leadership (MLK, non-violence, mass church rallies, national media coverage)
- Federal legal intervention (Supreme Court ruling in *Browder v. Gayle*, 14th Amendment supremacy)

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SECTION B: TIMED EXAM PAPER • QUESTION 3(D) (CONTINUED)

Complete your synthesis and reach a weighed, criteria-based conclusion.

Q3(D): CONCLUSION & JUDGEMENT

Conclusion Rule: State explicitly *how far* you agree with Interpretation 2 using your chosen criteria. Do not merely summarize.

SPaG Check: Capital letters for proper nouns (e.g. SCLC, Supreme Court, Vietcong).

[illegible]

PEARSON EDEXCEL LEVEL 4 MARK SCHEME [13-16 MARKS + 4 SPAG = 17-20 MARKS]:

- ☐ Both Interpretations Weighed ☐ Extensive Contextual Facts ☐ Sustained Evaluative Criteria ☐ Flawless SPaG & Specialist Terms

Exhaustive specification coverage. Practice an alternative high-yield exam question for this Key Topic.

4 Explain why the Brown v. Board of Education decision (1954) met with intense resistance in the Southern states. (12)

(You must also use information of your own.)

Earl Warren unanimous 9-0 ruling	"Separate is inherently unequal"
101 Southern congressmen	White Citizens' Councils (1954)
101st Airborne Division deployed	Closure of public schools

- **P1:** Southern Political Resistance: The Southern Manifesto signed by 101 congressmen urging states to resist federal tyranny.
- **P2:** State-Level Nullification & Little Rock: Governor Faubus deploying the National Guard to defy federal court desegregation orders.
- **P3:** Community & Economic Backlash (Own Knowledge): White Citizens' Councils intimidating Black parents and closing public schools.

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

SECTION C: HIGH-SCORING EXEMPLAR RESPONSES • SECTION A

Official Pearson Edexcel Level 2 & Level 4 continuous prose models with examiner annotations.

GRADE 8/9 MODELS: Q1 & Q2

QUESTION 1: SOURCE INFERENCE EXEMPLAR

FULL MARKS • LEVEL 2 (4/4)

Give two things you can infer from Source A about racial segregation in the American South in the early 1950s.

(i) What I can infer: I can infer that racial segregation was strictly enforced and institutionalized by municipal authorities rather than being merely informal discrimination.

Details in the source that tell me this: The source displays a prominent overhead street sign explicitly commanding "COLORED WAITING ROOM" with arrows directing Black travelers away from white areas.

(ii) What I can infer: I can infer that Black Americans were treated as second-class citizens and relegated to separate, segregated facilities in public transport. Details in the source that tell me this: The sign designates a completely separate waiting room specifically for "Colored" passengers, showing that basic facilities like waiting areas were racially divided under Jim Crow.

Examiner Annotation: Level 2 (4/4 Marks): Two valid, supported inferences drawn directly from the visual and textual evidence of the primary source.

QUESTION 2: CAUSATION ESSAY EXEMPLAR

FULL MARKS • LEVEL 4 (12/12)

Explain why it was difficult for Black Americans in the Southern states to register to vote in the early 1950s. (12 marks)

A fundamental reason why voter registration was exceedingly difficult was the systematic use of discriminatory literacy tests and poll taxes. Under the doctrine of states' rights, Southern registrars held unchecked authority to administer registration tests. Black applicants were routinely asked impossible, obscure questions—such as reciting complex sections of the state constitution or guessing the number of bubbles in a bar of soap. Poor Black citizens were also subjected to cumulative poll taxes, which intentionally priced impoverished sharecroppers out of democracy. As a result, fewer than 20% of eligible Black adults were registered across the South, and under 5% in rural Mississippi.

Furthermore, voter registration was severely impeded by the constant threat of white supremacist violence and terror. Vigilante groups such as the Ku Klux Klan (KKK) operated with complete judicial impunity across the Deep South. Black citizens who dared to approach registration offices were subjected to violent intimidation, nighttime cross-burnings, house firebombings, and lynchings. Because local police sheriffs were frequently Klan members or sympathizers, Black applicants knew that the law would not protect them, creating a paralyzing climate of fear that suppressed political mobilization.

Finally, registration was blocked by systematic economic coercion orchestrated by the White Citizens' Councils. Founded in 1944, these organizations of middle-class white professionals, bankers, and merchants used economic retaliation against any Black individual attempting to exercise civil rights. Black applicants had their names published in local newspapers, leading immediately to job dismissals, eviction from tenant farms, and the cancellation of bank credit and mortgages. This economic stranglehold ensured that even Black citizens willing to risk physical violence were deterred by the immediate prospect of financial ruin for their families.

Examiner Annotation: Level 4 (12/12 Marks): Fully developed 3-paragraph causal explanation; integrates both stimulus points alongside substantial own knowledge (White Citizens' Councils); precise historical facts and sustained analytical focus.

SECTION C: SECTION B MODELS & FATAL EXAMINER TRAPS

Official Level 3 & Level 4 continuous prose models and high-frequency pitfalls to avoid.

GRADE 8/9 MODELS: Q3 & TRAPS

QUESTION 3(A): SOURCE UTILITY EXEMPLAR

FULL MARKS · LEVEL 3 (8/8)

Source B is highly useful because it provides direct contemporary evidence of the rapid grassroots mobilization of the Black community. Written by Jo Ann Robinson and distributed by the Women's Political Council on 2 December 1955, the flyer reveals the strategic awareness of Black economic power, pointing out that "three-fourths of the riders are Negroes" and urging an immediate boycott. The utility is enhanced by its provenance: as an authentic working document distributed to 35,000 citizens, it proves that the boycott was organized by local women before national leaders took charge. However, its usefulness is limited as it only reflects the initial call to action, omitting the subsequent 381 days of walking and the 300-car pool network.

Source C is also extremely useful because it provides firsthand insight into the inspirational moral leadership of Dr Martin Luther King Jr. In his 5 December speech, King establishes the core philosophy of Christian non-violence and frames the boycott as a struggle for constitutional citizenship. The provenance makes it particularly valuable: as a speech delivered to 5,000 energized protesters, it shows how King maintained community morale and non-violent discipline despite police harassment and bomb threats. When evaluated together with knowledge that the Supreme Court's *Browder v. Gayle* ruling ultimately outlawed bus segregation in November 1956, both sources are exceptionally useful in demonstrating how grassroots logistics (Source B) and charismatic spiritual leadership (Source C) combined to achieve victory.

Examiner Annotation: Level 3 (8/8 Marks): Sophisticated evaluation of content, provenance (nature, origin, purpose), and contextual knowledge for both sources; weighs usefulness in relation to the specific enquiry.

QUESTION 3(B) & 3(C): INTERPRETATIONS EXEMPLAR

FULL MARKS · LEVEL 2 (4/4 + 4/4)

Q3(b) Difference: The main difference between the interpretations is that Interpretation 1 views the boycott as the achievement of working-class Black women and grassroots community logistics, whereas Interpretation 2 argues that success was primarily due to Dr Martin Luther King Jr.'s charismatic moral leadership and federal legal intervention. Interpretation 1 emphasizes that Jo Ann Robinson and the WPC organized the 35,000 leaflets and the 381-day walking protest, while Interpretation 2 asserts that King's rhetorical genius gave the movement national visibility and that only the Supreme Court's *Browder v. Gayle* ruling could legally force desegregation.

Q3(c) Reason: Interpretations 1 and 2 give different views because the historians have investigated different aspects of the historical evidence. The author of Interpretation 1 has relied on grassroots documentation such as Source B, focusing on the practical organizing efforts of the Women's Political Council and the economic power of domestic workers. Conversely, the author of Interpretation 2 has focused on high-profile public records and leadership speeches such as Source C, emphasizing Dr King's oratory, the church mass rallies, and the national constitutional legal battle in the federal courts.

Examiner Annotation: Q3b: Level 2 (4/4 Marks): Direct, clear contrast of main viewpoints using accurate supporting details from both interpretations. | Q3c: Level 2 (4/4 Marks): Explains differing interpretations by linking them explicitly to differing source material and historical emphases.

QUESTION 3(D): EVALUATIVE ESSAY CONCLUSION MODEL

FULL MARKS · LEVEL 4 (16+4 = 20/20)

In conclusion, I agree with Interpretation 2 to a substantial extent, because without Dr King's inspirational moral leadership and the binding constitutional authority of the federal courts, the boycott could never have achieved permanent legal desegregation. King's philosophy of Christian non-violence maintained community discipline across 381 days of terror, while his national profile secured essential financial backing from northern sympathizers. Most decisively, municipal authorities adamantly refused to compromise despite severe commercial losses; only the Supreme Court's landmark ruling in *Browder v. Gayle* (November 1956) legally outlawed bus segregation under the 14th Amendment. However, Interpretation 2 understates the indispensable grassroots mobilization highlighted in Interpretation 1. Without Jo Ann Robinson, the Women's Political Council, and thousands of domestic workers sustaining the intricate 300-car pool network, there would have been no platform for King to lead or legal challenge for the courts to uphold. Therefore, while grassroots heroism created the crisis, charismatic leadership and federal judicial power were the decisive catalysts that transformed local resistance into historic victory.

Examiner Annotation: Level 4 (16+4 = 20/20 Marks): Sustained, criteria-based historiographical judgement; balances both interpretations with extensive own knowledge; nuanced conclusion weighing grassroots resistance against federal judicial power.

TOP 3 FATAL EXAMINER TRAPS TO AVOID FOR KEY TOPIC 1

• Rosa Parks was NOT an accidental protester

Do not describe Rosa Parks as an exhausted seamstress who simply acted on impulse. She was a seasoned NAACP secretary trained in civil disobedience at the Highlander Folk School.

• Economic pressure alone did NOT desegregate buses

The bus company suffered crippling financial losses, but city ordinances forbade integration. Desegregation occurred strictly because the Supreme Court ruled in *Browder v. Gayle* that bus segregation violated the 14th Amendment.

• The Boycott did NOT desegregate Montgomery

The 1956 victory applied strictly to municipal public buses. All other public facilities in Montgomery—schools, restaurants, swimming pools, and waiting rooms—remained fiercely segregated.